

Benjamin Cohen

Senior Software Engineer

📞 (516) 668-3981 ✉️ bac1087@gmail.com

📍 New York, NY · open to relocation

🌐 thealoofbuddha.dev linkedin.com/in/aloofbuddha github.com/AloofBuddha

Design-oriented senior software engineer who owns the frontend end-to-end (React, TypeScript, GraphQL, testing, CI/CD) and partners closely with product and design to ship polished, delightful, high-conversion experiences. Strong foundation in teaching developers, building design systems, and architecting complex UIs. Passionate about exploring how **AI-native interfaces** can make powerful tools more intuitive and accessible - especially for developers.

EXPERIENCE



SoFi

Dec 2023 – Jul 2025

Senior Software Engineer

- Co-led rollout of SoFi's unified design system, building reusable React components adopted by **6+ product teams**.
- Redesigned the Student Loan Refinancing funnel with said design system and partnered with backend teams to transition API layer from REST to GraphQL.
- Designed and implemented A/B experiments improving conversion by ~3% resulting in a **\$12M monthly revenue lift**.

React · TypeScript · GraphQL · Optimizely



Code Platoon

Oct 2022 – Oct 2023

Lead Software Instructor

- Taught modern full-stack development at a not-for-profit helping military veterans transition to software careers.
- Rewrote our assessments and built an automated GitHub Actions pipeline for instant feedback and CI/CD grading, reducing assessment turnaround **from days to seconds**.

React · JavaScript · GitHub Actions · Python · Django



DUOS

Nov 2021 – Oct 2022

Senior Software Engineer

- Owned all frontend surfaces (marketing, internal ops, and consumer mobile) for DUOS's senior-care platform.
- Built robust automated testing (unit, integration, e2e) integrated with CI/CD to ensure rapid, stable releases.

React · React Native · TypeScript · MUI · Jest · Cypress



ServiceMaster

May 2019 – Oct 2021

Frontend Developer III

- Delivered full redesign of flagship brand sites and checkout flow, modernizing UX for millions of annual users
- Introduced automated test coverage (Jest, Cypress) that ensure feature parity and minimize regressions as we transitioned to the new site architecture.

Ember.js · React · Jest · Cypress

Software Instructor

- Early engineer/instructor at one of the first major coding bootcamps (successfully acquired in 2019).
- Delivered lectures on full-stack development and led curriculum migration from Angular 1.x to React.
- **Mentored hundreds of engineers** now at top tech companies

Angular 1.x · React · Node.js · Express · PostgreSQL

Software Development Engineer

- Developed internal UI tools enabling support engineers to train early AI models (Cortana) on Windows and Office troubleshooting flows.

Angular 1.x · C# · ASP.NET

Research Assistant

- Built NLP classifier for hotel review fraud detection, improving model accuracy from 89% → 94% using NLTK and scikit-learn.
- Contributed to the design of a statically-typed functional scripting language ("Big Bang") with full type inference in Haskell.

Python · NLTK · scikit-learn · Haskell · C++

HIGHLIGHTED PROJECTS

CollabCanvas

[Live Site](#) · [GitHub](#) · [Demo](#)

Real-time collaborative whiteboard with **AI-powered natural language commands**. Users can manipulate canvas elements through conversational prompts ('create 10 red circles, align vertically with 10px gaps') leveraging GPT-4 with custom RAG for canvas context awareness. Supports batch operations and high-level UI generation. Built to explore AI-native interaction patterns—learning firsthand where LLMs excel (structured commands) vs. struggle (complex spatial reasoning, layering specifically). React + Firebase + OpenAI API.

React · Firebase · TypeScript · Konva · Zustand · OpenAI API

LLM UI

[Live Site](#) · [GitHub](#) · [Demo](#)

Claude-inspired chat interface for xAI's Grok API featuring **real-time streaming** responses and an innovative explanation pane for contextual lookups. Select any text in the chat to get instant explanations from Dictionary, Wikipedia, or AI-powered summaries. Includes persistent chat history, markdown rendering with GitHub-flavored syntax, and LaTeX equation support.

React · TypeScript · Vite · Vercel · xAI API · SSE

SKILLS

 React / Next.js

 TypeScript

 GraphQL

 Jest / Cypress

 Product UI / UX

 Teaching / Mentorship

 Performance & Architecture

 AI-Driven UX / Experimentation

EDUCATION

Johns Hopkins University — B.S. Computer Science · GPA 3.7 / 4.0 · Upsilon Pi Epsilon